

John Micah Mercado

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly motivated Software Engineer with a 3.95 GPA and hands-on cybersecurity experience in penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and secure coding. Skilled in SQL injection testing, session hijacking, reverse TCP payload deployment, and mitigating OWASP Top 10 threats. Holds CompTIA Security+ certification with strong knowledge of networking, encryption, and risk mitigation. Proficient in full-stack development (React.js, Node.js, MySQL) with security integrated throughout the SDLC. Proven ability to independently architect and deploy secure applications from concept to deployment.

EDUCATION

University of North Florida

July 2026

B.S. Information Technology, Summa Cum Laude. GPA: 3.96.

Relevant Coursework: Computer Networks, Cloud Computing, Cybersecurity Systems, Intrusion Detection, Forensics, Systems Administration, Computer Programming, IT Project Management

PROJECTS

Web Development Projects (Personal, JavaScript, HTML, CSS)

July 2026

- Passenger counter app with real-time count updates using HTML/CSS/JavaScript.
- Browser-based Blackjack game with player-vs-dealer logic and score tracking.
- Chrome extension for capturing and exporting sales leads from web pages.
- Personal portfolio website built with HTML/CSS and hosted on GitHub Pages.
- Developed a full-stack web application Rock Paper Scissors game using Express, React, TypeScript, and SQLite3.

FinCal: Financial Calculator App (Personal, Java/Kotlin)

May 2026 – July 2026

- Building an Android app with financial calculators covering mortgage, investment, retirement, and tax planning.
- Implementing core financial formulas including compound interest, loan amortization, and ROI using Java and Kotlin.
- Designing category-based UI navigation with Jetpack Compose and input validation.
- Managing project in GitHub for version control, tracking, and app distribution.

Customer Churn Pipeline (Personal, C#)

March 2026 – March 2026

- Built a C# application using classes and collections to read, parse, and process customer data from CSV files, including product lists and engagement metrics.
- Developed logic to analyze user behavior — login frequency, spending, tenure, and support issues — to identify customers at high risk of churn.
- Implemented file handling, data validation, and input/output operations to clean, structure, and analyze customer records.

Cybersecurity Projects

June 2024 – December 2025

- Set up packet sniffing with Wireshark to capture HTTP/HTTPS traffic, extracted session cookies, and demonstrated real-world session replay attacks before applying encryption and secure flag configurations.
- Deployed reverse TCP payloads on target machines using custom Python scripts, established persistent channels, and executed post-exploitation data exfiltration in controlled lab environments.
- Conducted live session hijacking demonstrations using stolen cookies and session tokens, then implemented secure session management with rotation, expiration policies, and fingerprinting to prevent unauthorized access.
- Performed hands-on SQL injection attacks on vulnerable test environments and implemented parameterized queries, input validation, and WAF rules to remediate identified vulnerabilities.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+, CompTIA, December 2024
- Level 1: Excel White Belt, McGraw Hill
- Level 1: Word White Belt, McGraw Hill
- Level 1: PowerPoint White Belt, McGraw Hill

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Kotlin, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, C++

Technologies and Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, React.js, REST API, HTML, CSS, Node.js, MySQL, SQLite3, Docker, Express.js, Open API, JWT, JSON

Office and Productivity: Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Word, Microsoft Access